

iQOO Neo 10

An all-rounder in performance

When I first heard that iQOO was planning to launch the Neo 10 in India, I was pretty excited. Not just because it would be a solid performance phone at a great price, but also because it had the potential to be one of the most hyped mid-range smartphones of 2025. The Neo 10, as of now, feels like the natural successor to the super popular iQOO Neo 9 Pro, and, of course, it's the next entry in the 'Neo' series, which always brings something interesting.

Now, iQOO has already made a name for itself in the smartphone market, especially among gamers who want top-tier performance without breaking the bank. But over time, the brand has been trying to strike a balance by focusing not just on raw power, but also on areas like camera and display. And after testing their last three smartphones, I can say with confidence: iQOO is heading in the right direction, making its phones a 'performance-centric all-rounder'.

But here comes the twist – the iQOO Neo 10. On paper, this phone sounds really good: Snapdragon 8s Gen 4 (a slightly toned-down version of the Snapdragon 8 Elite), a massive 7000mAh battery, a 144Hz 1.5K OLED panel, up to 16GB RAM. These specs are very similar to that of the previously launched iQOO Neo 10R.

Is that a problem? Read the full review, and you will know.

DESIGN

Imagine if the iQOO 13 (tinyurl.com/3cxr86wr) and the iQOO Neo 10R (tinyurl.com/mw3hst52) had a baby, you would get the iQOO Neo 10, with more DNA leaning towards the Neo 10R. It comes in two colour options: Inferno Red (which honestly looks more orange

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than red) and Titanium Chrome (which gives a more premium in-hand feel). The design language here feels very familiar, pretty much what we saw on the Neo 10R. That same Gen-Z energy, racing-inspired back panel, and the whole "I'm here to win tournaments and scroll Instagram" kind of vibe.

On the front, you get a 6.78-inch display with a punch-hole cutout for the selfie camera and an in-screen optical fingerprint scanner that unlocks in literal milliseconds. The display is protected by Gorilla Glass 7i, and the phone also comes with an IP65 rating for dust and water resistance. Though I would still suggest keeping it away from water as much as possible.

In terms of daily usability, the iQOO Neo 10 is a pretty decent device to carry around. Last week, I was testing it alongside the Neo 10R, keeping both phones together in one pocket and my

iPhone 16 Pro Max in the other, and surprisingly, it didn't feel uncomfortable at all. The iQOO Neo 10 weighs around 206 grams, but thanks to solid weight distribution and a sleek profile (even with that massive 7000mAh battery inside), it doesn't feel bulky.

But if we're talking purely aesthetics, I would personally go for the Titanium Chrome variant. This Inferno Orange....sorry, Red, just isn't my thing.

DISPLAY

The iQOO Neo 10 comes with a 6.78-inch 1.5K AMOLED panel that supports 10-bit colour, HDR, and a 144Hz refresh rate, though the 144Hz kicks in only on select apps. Visually, yes, the display looks bright and beautiful. But more than just being pretty, this one also produces natural colours.

According to our Calman testing, the iQOO Neo 10 scored a delta E of 1.4, which still puts it in the excellent range. That means its colour accuracy is top-notch, and it also makes it ideal for creators, designers, or anyone who cares about true-to-life visuals.

Now, coming to brightness, in our test lab, we recorded a peak screen brightness of 3340 nits on Auto mode. That's straight-up flagship territory. Even in bright outdoor conditions, the display stays super visible with minimal glare. Whether you're gaming, watching content, or just scrolling, the screen holds up perfectly under sunlight.

And of course, that 144Hz refresh rate makes everything feel smooth. You also get the option to manually select which apps run at 144Hz, and thankfully, the list isn't limited. You can enable it for almost all your go-to apps.

PERFORMANCE

Among all the components, if I had high hopes for anything on the Neo 10, it was the Snapdragon 8s Gen 4. This processor is paired with up to 16GB of RAM and 512GB of storage (which is the variant I've been using). All of my testing has been done with Monster Mode enabled, which essentially pushes the phone to its peak performance levels.